

Bulk File Rename

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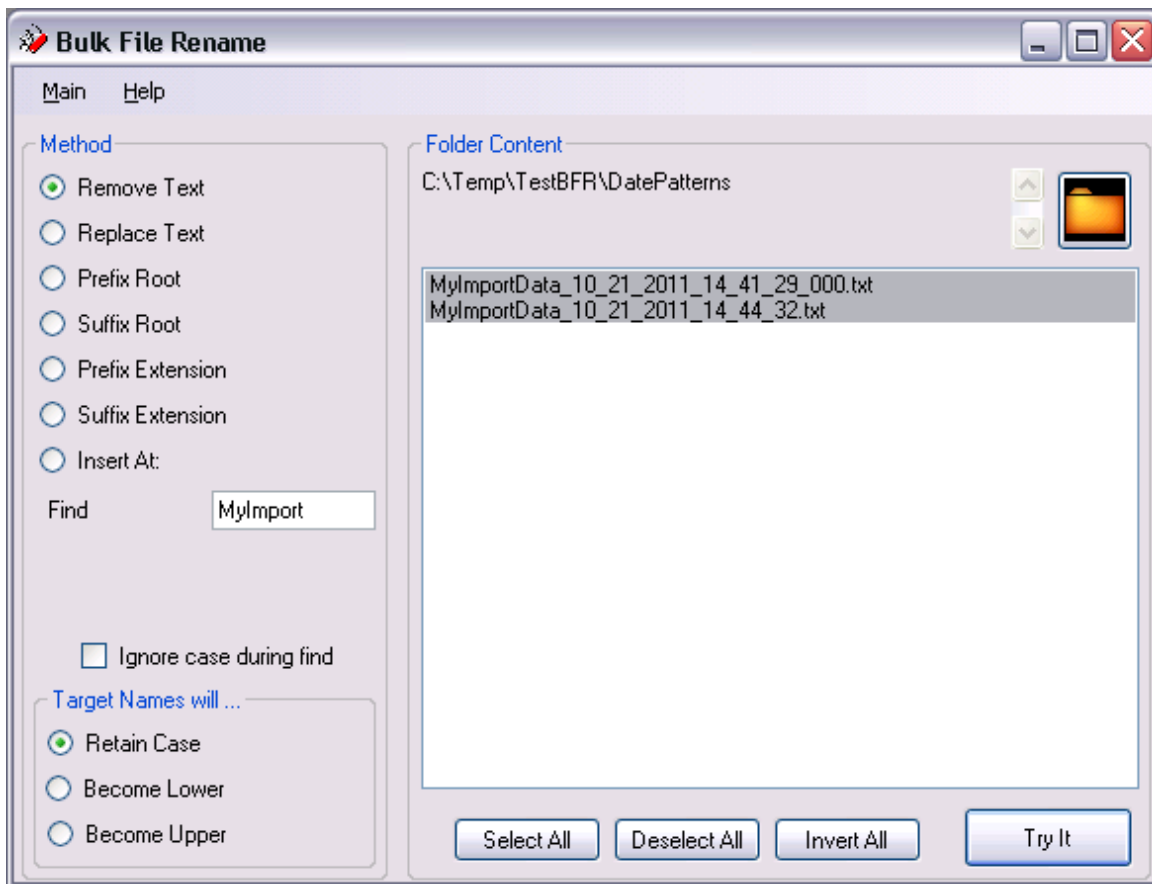
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Purpose

Bulk File Rename allows you to select a group of files in a folder, and rename them using a simple or complex pattern. It only supports user interaction (i.e. no batch mode). I wrote this utility for those times, when a large number of files had malformed names, and the standard console rename command was incapable of making the change.

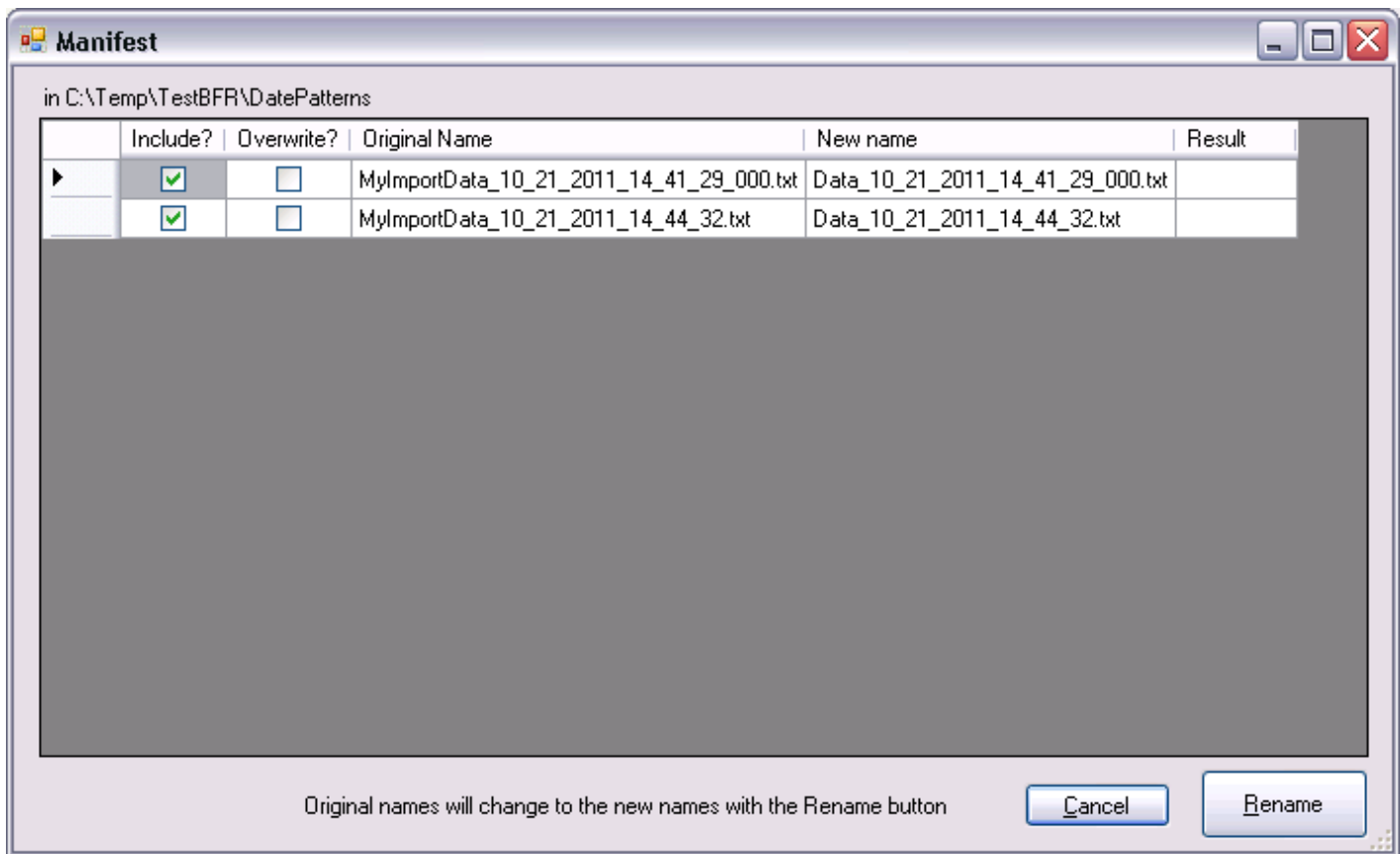
Using the program

Select the program from the start menu, or right-click on any folder and select Bulk File Rename to start the application in the selected directory. You will see the following form:



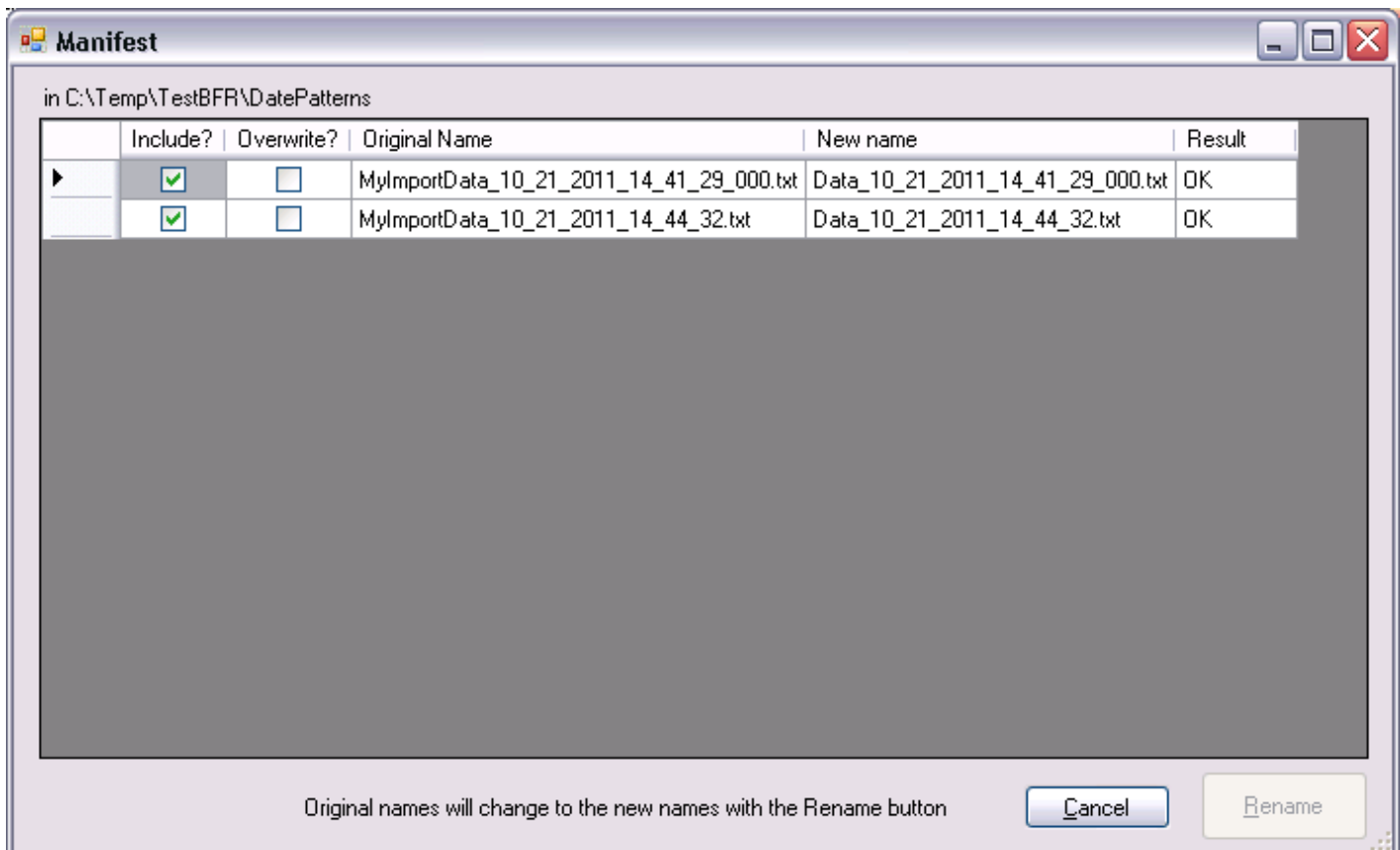
First select the folder with the files you wish to rename. You can this by either selecting Main/Select Folder from the drop-down menus, or clicking the folder icon to the right of the current directory in use. Navigate to the folder using the standard Windows file dialog. To select the folder, double-click on any file in that folder.

The dialog will the display the files in that folder. On the right, select how you wish to rename the files, and then select the files (use Ctrl+left-click to select/deselect multiple files) to process. Then click on the Try It button, which will display the preview windows, as below.

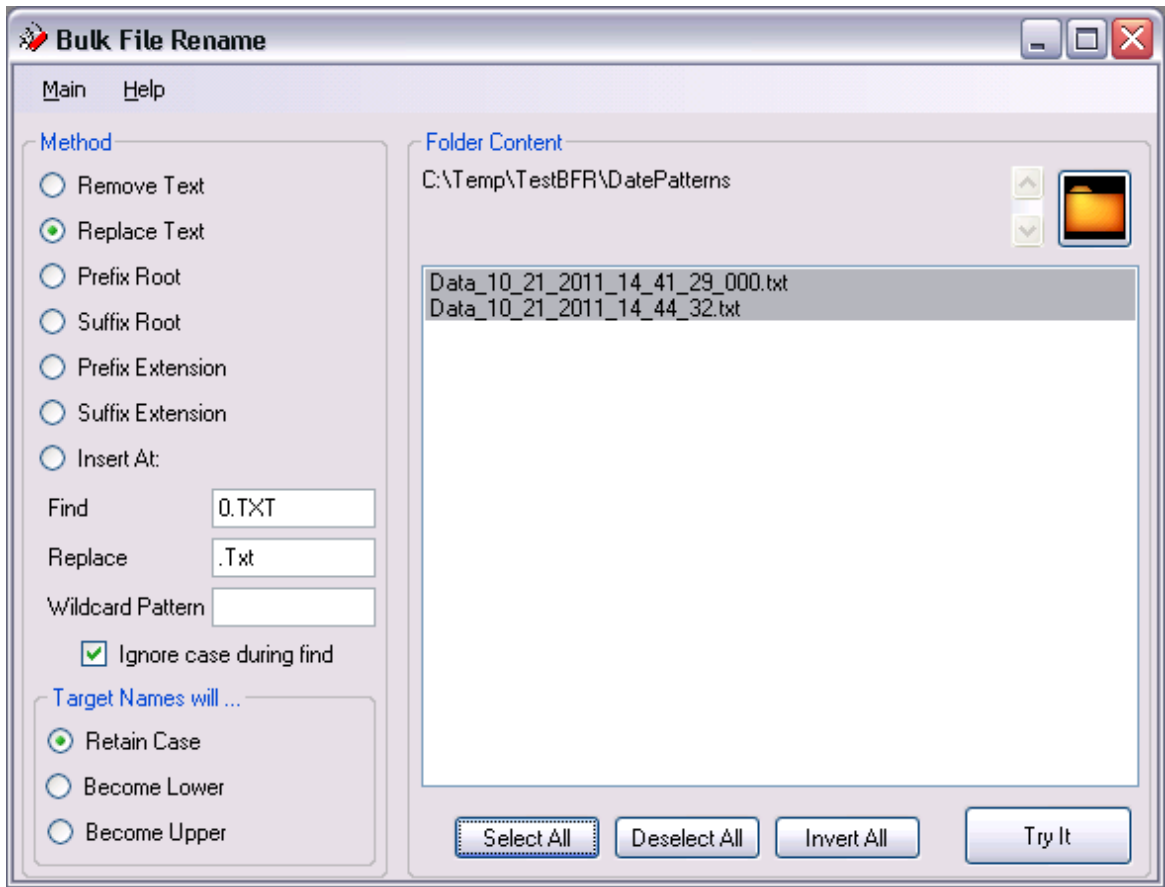


In the result column, files which will have conflicting names during the rename process will be marked as such in the result column: a blank value indicates no conflict detected.

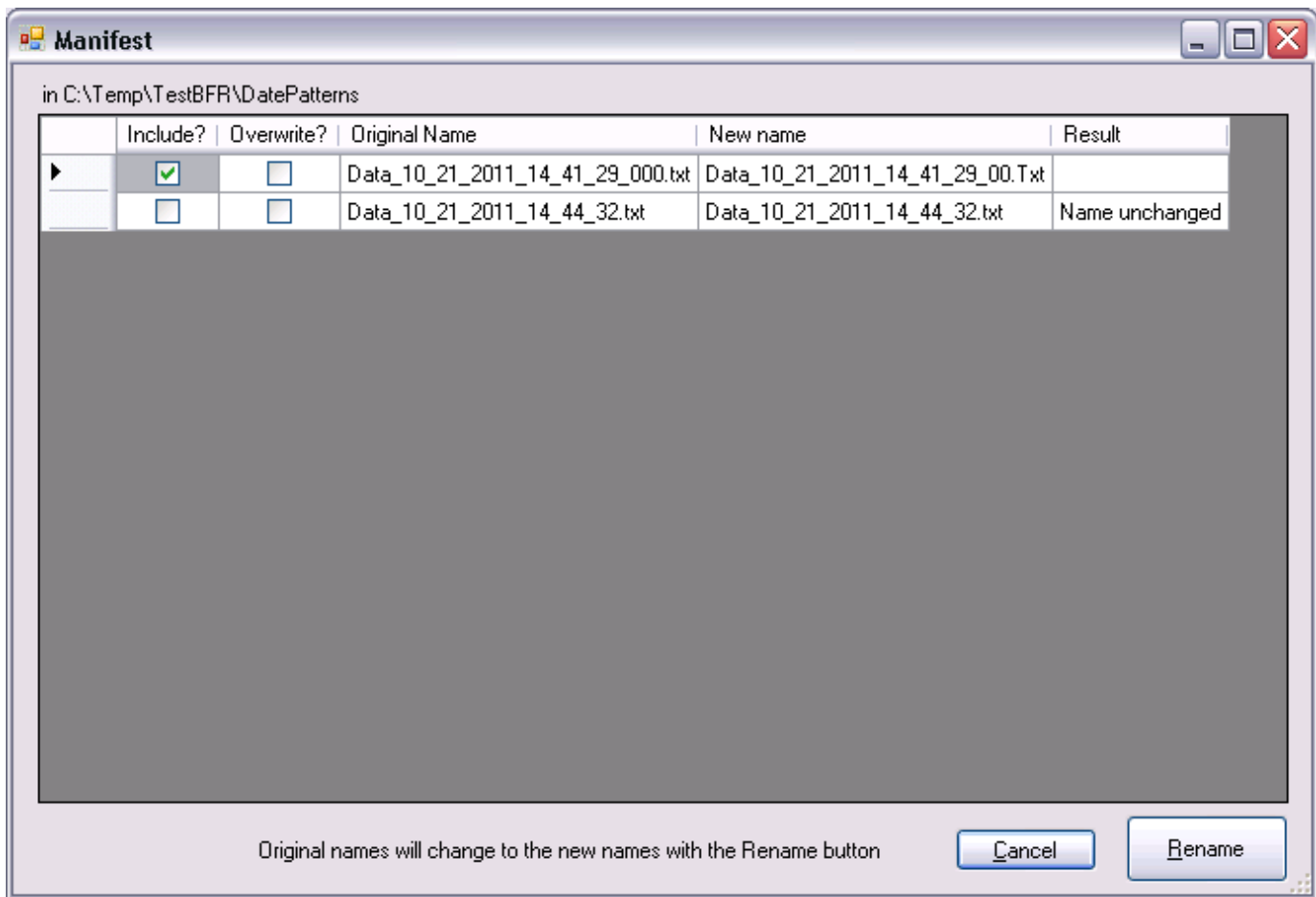
Once everything looks as it should, click the Rename button to actually rename the files. The result column next to each file will have either OK, or a description of the problem encountered.



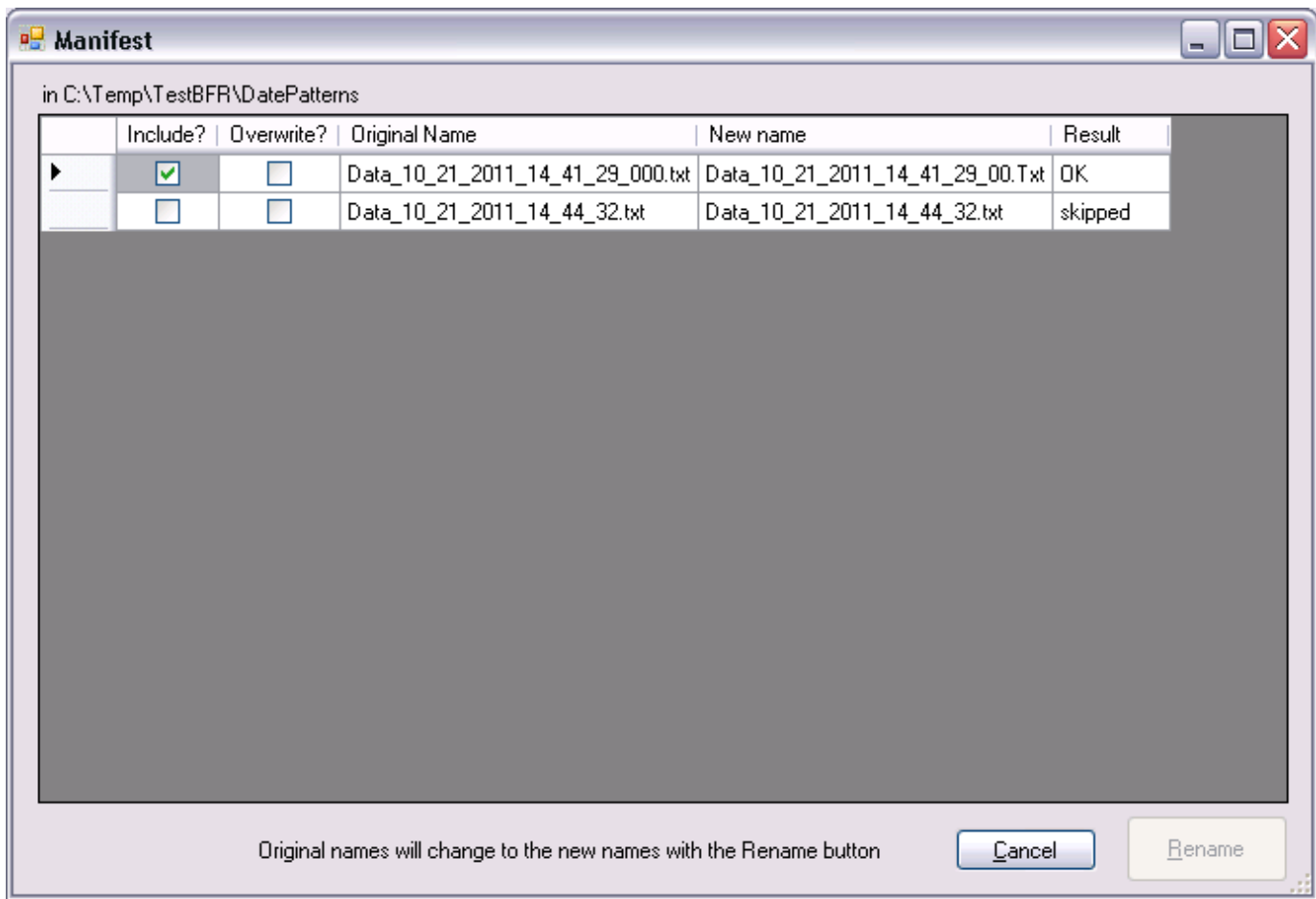
That is the basic use of the application. The application also has a certain amount of intelligence built-in to prevent renaming actions where none are needed. As an example...



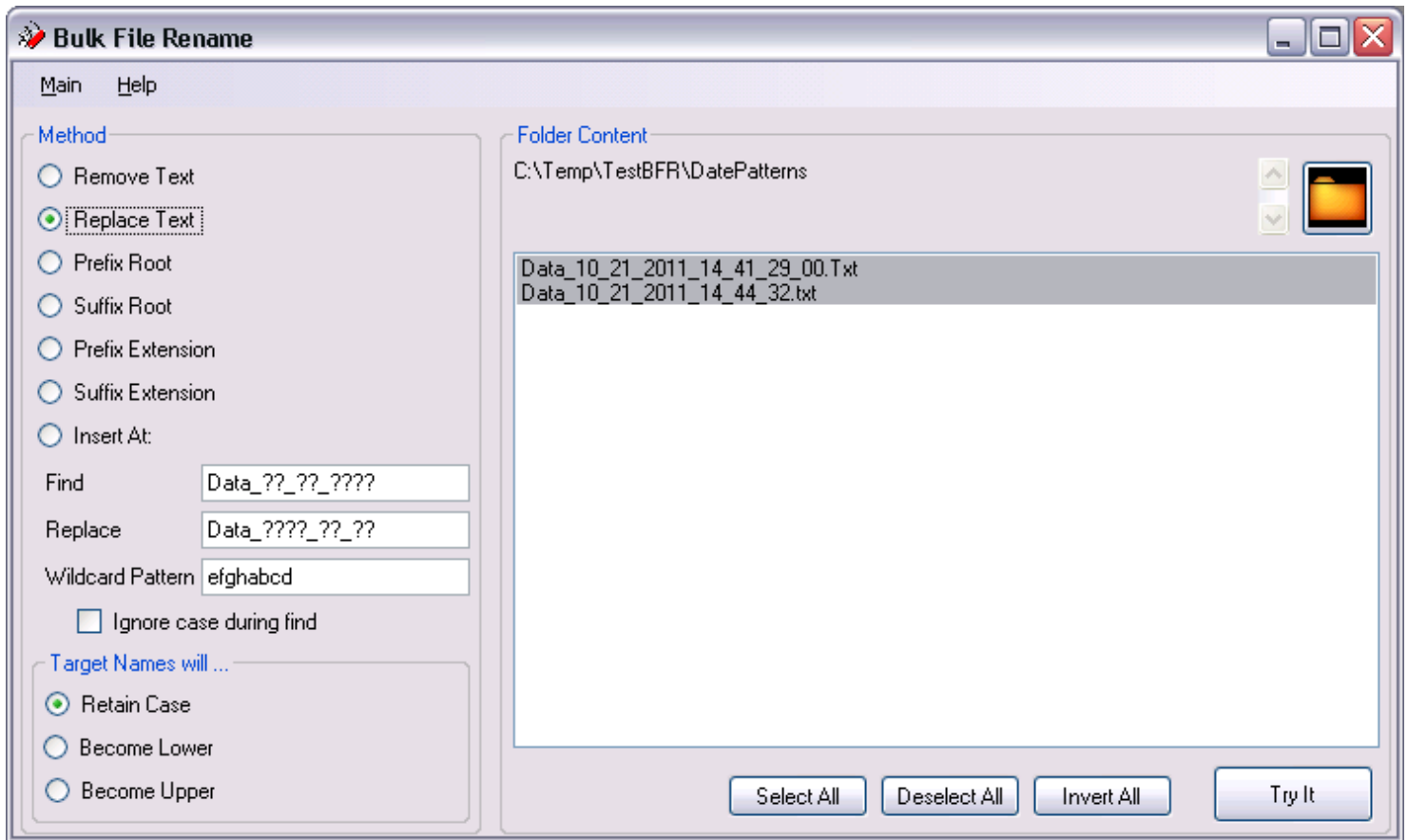
This rename action has a file selected, which will not match the find pattern, and one that does. When the Try It button is clicked the file which is not renamed is automatically deselected in list (the include column is not checked) and the result is marked as "name unchanged". When the Rename button is clicked...



... the result is skipped for any file not having the "Include?" column checked.

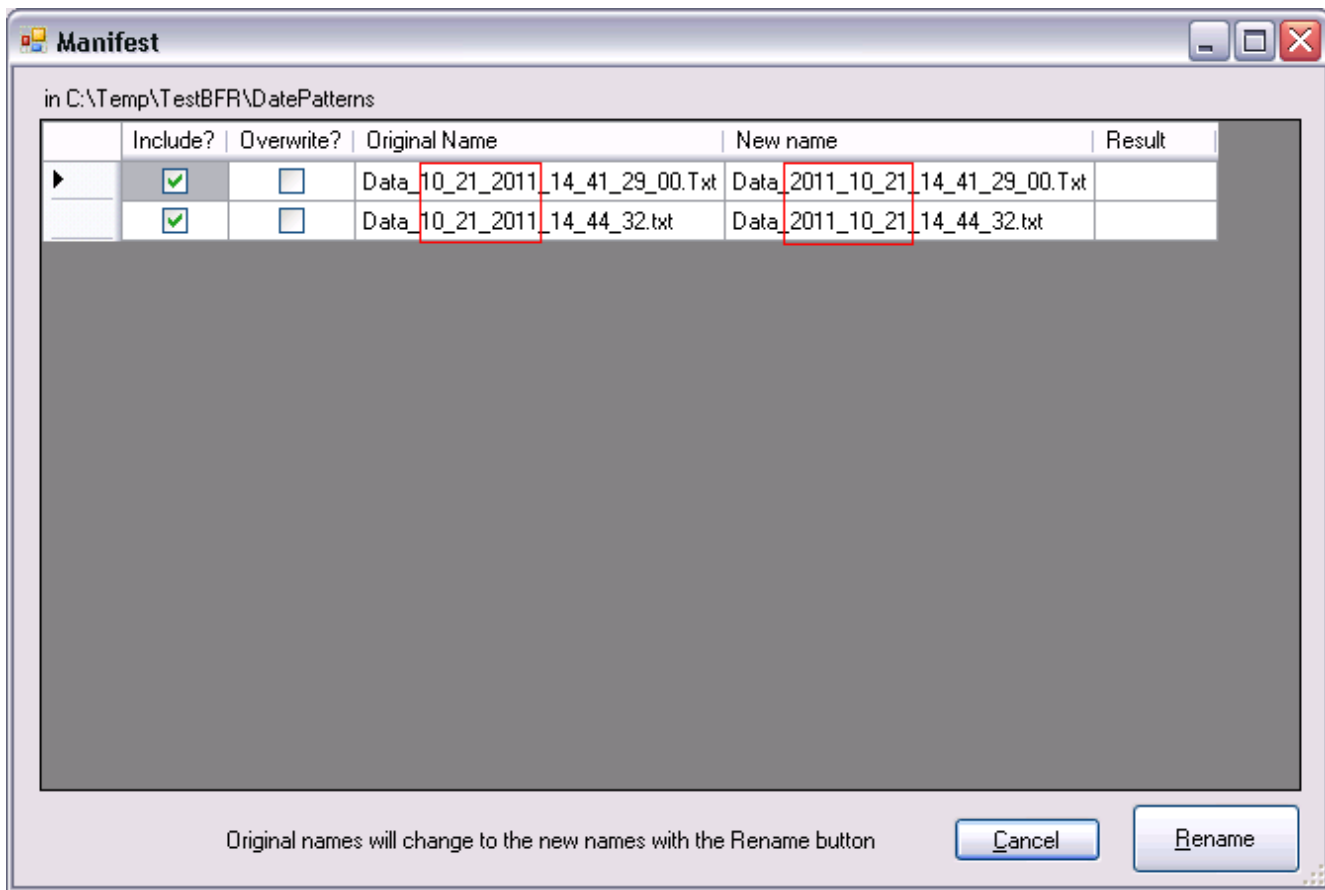


The real power of this renaming utility is in its ability to use wild cards, and the ability to shuffle characters inherited in the new name. To demonstrate this, here is an example of file which are using a non-ANSI date pattern in the files' root name...



In this renaming scheme, the find has a number of question marks (wild cards) to represent a character. The replace string has essentially the same pattern with wildcards, but the replace wildcards are an ANSI pattern like YYYY-MM-DD. The wildcard pattern contains a sequence of alphabetic characters, used to compare the original positions (abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz...) with the positions those characters should relocate to. So if the find pattern was "???s_is_a_fox", the replace pattern is "??s_is_a_fox_?" and the wildcard pattern was "cba", the name "This_is_a_fox" would mutate to "ihs_is_a_fox_T".

Only wildcard characters are affected by the pattern. The wildcard pattern in the screen shot is what is needed to move the YYYY MM DD components of the source date (non-ANSI) to the new ANSI format in the replace value. Wildcards are quite flexible and powerful.



Wildcards require a bit of experimentation to see their power and potential. That's about all there is for functionality.. enjoy!